

UNIT 04

KING BRUCE AND THE SPIDER (POEM)

WORDS AND MEANING

S. #	Words	Meaning in English	Meaning in Urdu
2.	Bravo	Expression of approval or admiration	بہترین، شاباش
3.	Clue	A hint or piece of evidence	اشارہ، ثبوت
4.	Ceiling	Upper interior surface of a room	چھت
5.	Cobweb	A spider's silk web typically found in corners	مکھی کا جال
6.	Despair	Loss of hope; feeling of hopelessness	مایوسی، ناامیدی
7.	In a low despair	Feeling hopeless or despondent to a great extent	مایوسی میں، ناامیدی میں
8.	To divine	To perceive or predict through intuition or insight	پیشینگوئی کرنا، خدا کا علم کرنا
9.	Dizzy	Feeling lightheaded or unsteady	چکر آنا، بے توازن
10.	Delicate	Fragile, easily broken or damaged	نازک، کمزور
11.	Down in came with the slippery sprawl	Fell down in a slippery and sprawling manner	بے قابو گرنا، پھسل کر گرنا
12.	Endeavour	An earnest or determined effort	کوشش کرنا، محنت کرنا
13.	Fine	Of high quality or good appearance	خوبصورت، عمدہ، بہترین
14.	To fling oneself down	To throw oneself down with force	خود کو زور داری سے پھینکنا
15.	Grieved	Felt deep sorrow or sadness	رنجیدہ ہونا، دکھی ہونا
16.	Gossips	Casual or idle talk about other people's affairs	گپ شپ، کہانیاں سننا
17.	Head grew steady	Head became stable or no longer dizzy	سر مضبوط ہونا، چکر کم ہونا
18.	The last pinch	The final bit or instance of something	آخری موقع، آخری لمحہ
19.	Monarch	A king or queen who holds supreme power	بادشاہ، راجا
20.	To mount	To climb or ascend	چڑھنا، بلند ہونا
21.	Native cot	A traditional bed made from woven material	دیہاتی کٹیا، چارپائی
22.	Pondered	Thought about deeply or carefully	غور کرنا، سوچنا
23.	To strive	To make a great effort or struggle	محنت کرنا، جدوجہد کرنا
24.	Utter	To speak or express something	اظہار کرنا، بولنا
25.	To toil	To work hard and continuously	محنت کرنا، کوشش کرنا
26.	Tread	To step or walk on something	چلنا، راہ لینا

27.	To tumble	To fall suddenly or clumsily	گرنہ، چکرانا
28.	Wear	The act of wearing or the state of being worn	پہننا، استعمال کا اثر

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Q1: What was the lesson King Bruce learned from the spider?

Ans. The spider's persistent efforts positively influenced King Bruce's perspective, teaching him the importance of determination and courage in pursuing life's goals. The spider's unwavering struggle demonstrated that consistent perseverance in the face of challenges leads to favorable outcomes. This lesson encourages us to persevere, overcome obstacles, and remain resolute regardless of life's adversities.

Q2: Can you provide some insights into King Bruce of Scotland? OR Share a brief overview of King Bruce of Scotland.

Ans. King Bruce of Scotland was a benevolent and patriotic ruler. He once confronted the British Army, which aimed to establish British dominance in Scotland, but suffered defeat. Despite setbacks, his determination to regain control prompted numerous efforts, all of which ended in failure.

OR

King Bruce, reigning over Scotland, displayed patriotism and generosity. Engaged in a conflict with the British Army striving to establish a colony in Scotland, he faced defeat. Disheartened by repeated failures, he initially resolved not to continue trying. However, his encounter with a spider rekindled his hope and courage. Bolstered by this newfound inspiration, he undertook another attempt, ultimately succeeding.

Q3: Who is the poet behind this poem? Can you provide a brief introduction to the poet/poetess?

Ans. Eliza Cook (1818-1889) is the poetess of this poem. Born in London, she edited and published "Eliza Cook's Journal" in 1849. Her works are characterized by their simplicity and strong moral themes. She practiced what she preached in her life, advocating for persistence and determination in the face of adversity.

Q4: What does the poetess mean by the phrase "a great deed"?

Ans. When the poetess mentions "a great deed," she is referring to the significant endeavor undertaken by King Bruce. His efforts to safeguard his territory from the hands of the enemy are likened to a remarkable achievement. The protection of one's country holds immense importance, thus earning the title of "a great deed."

Q5: What commonality does the poetess find between King Bruce and the Spider?

Ans. The poetess highlights the shared similarity between King Bruce and the spider in their pursuit of distant goals. Both faced seemingly insurmountable odds and held onto faint hopes for success. The spider's single thread to its cobweb parallels King Bruce's slim chance of triumphing over his adversaries.

Q6: Why did the poetess and King Bruce commend the spider with "Bravo! bravo!?" How did King Bruce express his admiration for the spider?

Ans. The praise "Bravo! bravo!" was directed at the spider due to its persistent and unwavering efforts. Despite repeated failures, the spider remained undeterred,

demonstrating determination and resilience. This relentless striving impressed King Bruce, leading him to appreciate the spider's tenacity. In this display of courage, King Bruce found inspiration and a lesson in success.

Q7: What is the moral of this poem?

Ans. The poem imparts the moral lesson that one should not succumb to discouragement and despair in the face of unfavorable circumstances. Instead, one should persistently strive and persevere through failures. The poem emphasizes that failures serve as stepping stones to success.

Q8: How many attempts did the spider make?

Ans. The spider made a total of nine valiant attempts before achieving success on the tenth try.

Q9: What made King Bruce decide to continue his efforts?

Ans. After observing the spider's struggle, King Bruce altered his decision and chose not to give up. He realized that success is determined by one's resolve and willpower. Learning from the spider's example, he resolved to persistently strive until he achieved his goal.

Q10: How did the spider manage to reach its cobweb?

Ans. Initially, the spider had fallen from its cobweb in the ceiling and was suspended by a delicate silken thread. Despite facing failure in nine attempts, the spider remained undaunted. On the tenth attempt, it succeeded in reaching the cobweb, showcasing its determination and ultimate success.